CHAPTER 10

Tourism

Goa has emerged as a foremost tourist destination in the country, both for domestic and foreign tourists because of its positive tourism profile in the form of natural scenic beauty, golden and silvery beaches, man-made artistic monuments, rivers and rivulets, springs, lakes and waterfalls, safety aspects, a blend of the eastern and the western culture, very friendly and hospitable people which make Goa a veritable tourist paradise. Tourism in Goa today, is one of the major economic activities with a multiplier effect which percolates to the local population.

Tourism is being diversified to hinterland by promoting heritage tourism, village tourism, eco-tourism etc. Goa being a treasure of heritage, centuries old temples, churches, forts, monuments, houses etc. depicts rich art and cultural heritage of Goa. Beautification of important touristic destinations, improvement of roads in tourist circuit and improvement of different safety measures, regular sight-seeing tours, cruises, tour packages, easy access to accommodation etc. are the areas of attraction for the tourist flow. Development of all such destinations have caused significant tourist inflow in Goa.

a. Tourist Arrivals

In order to promote Goa as an ideal tourist destination, continuous efforts are being made through print and electronic media. Aggressive media campaign has been continuing and is showing positive effects from tourists arrival point of view. Besides, the Department of Tourism has been participating in various travel related overseas events like India @60 at New York from 23rd to 26th September 2007 and a Road show was organized in 5 Star Hotel, Manhattan on 25th September 2007, World Travel Mart at London from 12th to 15th November 2007 and domestic event in India International Trade Fair at New Delhi from 14th to 27th September 2007. In order to improve services to the tourists, development of infrastructure facilities, beautification of important touristic destinations, improvement of roads in tourists circuit, providing Sulabh Sauchalaya for convenience on touristic site and improvement of different safety measures have been continuing. To supplement beach tourism, the department will associate to

promote Goa as medical tourism destination in view of good facilities available to the tourists as well as low cost of treatment available in Goa. The trend in tourist arrivals and arrivals by charter flights from 1991 is given in table 10.1 & 10.2 respectively.

The tourist arrival in Goa during the year 2007 is 25,69,874 (P) of which 3,97,377 were foreign tourist. The Hotel bed capacity has gone up from 39,335 to 40,341. From October 2007 to 3rd December 2007 the number of tourists arrivals are 33,989 by 125 Charter flights and 13 condor flights brought 2780 tourists.

Table 10.1: Tourist Arrivals in Goa 1991-2008

Year	Number of Tourists			Annual Growth (%)
	Domestic	Foreign	Total	
1991	756786	78281	835067	-5.6
1992	774568	121442	896010	7.3
1993	798576	170658	969234	8.2
1994	849404	210191	1059595	9.3
1995	878487	229218	1107705	4.5
1996	888914	237216	1126130	1.7
1997	928925	261673	1190598	5.7
1998	953212	275047	1228259	3.2
1999	960114	284298	1244412	1.3
2000	976804	291709	1268513	1.9
2001	1120242	260071	1380313	8.8
2002	1325296	271645	1596941	15.7
2003	1725140	314357	2039497	27.7
2004	2085729	363230	2448959	20.1
2005	1965343	336803	2302146	-6.0
2006	2098654	380414	2479068	7.7
2007(P)	2172497	397377	2569874	3.4

Table 10.2 : Arrivals by Charter Flights (October to May)

Year	No. of Flights	Passengers
1990-91	41	5815
1991-92	121	17102
1992-93	259	39871
1993-94	299	58369
1994-95	313	59881
1995-96	337	75694
1996-97	282	73172
1997-98	350	88817
1998-99	356	90635
1999-2000	405	94289
2000-2001	419	116992
2001-2002	279	76410
2002-2003	384	94350
2003-2004	532	126255
2004-2005	690	158993
2005-2006	719	180310
2006-2007	720	169836
2007-2008*	235	63561

Source: Department of Tourism, Government of Goa.
* Upto December 2007

Achievements

- Development of car parking facilities at Mahalasa temple, Mardol is in progress.
- Construction work of culvert at Betalbatim beach is in progress.
- Construction of Sulabh Souchalayas at Bhrama karmali is in progress.
- Land admeasuring 2172 sq.mts. has been acquired at Salmona spring in Saligao for beautification.
- 258 shacks, 168 in North Goa and 90 in South Goa have been permitted on identified beaches for the tourist season 2007-08.
- 61 life guards have been deployed on different identified beaches for safety of visiting tourists.
- Goa Tourism has won the Best Beach Destination award at India International Trade Fair held at New Delhi from 14th to 27th September 2007.

b Investment/Assistance/Loan to Public Sector Undertaking

- The Goa Tourism Development Corporation Ltd., a State Public Sector Undertaking is running a number of activities on commercial lines competing with private sector. The various commercial activities include providing accommodation, conducting sightseeing tours/cruises, release of souvenirs, promoting tour packages, etc. In order to make the Corporation to embark on a professional growth path, the Government invests in the Share Capital of the Corporation to boost/strengthen its financial base.
- A scheme viz. 'Radio Taxi in the State of Goa' is proposed by the Tourism Department to be operated through Goa Tourism Development Corporation Ltd.(GTDC) on trial basis for the first year. The vehicles shall be purchased by the department and shall be placed with GTDC to allocate it to the various unemployed graduates having valid driving license and interested to run the taxi. The GTDC will fix a norm to collect a certain amount per month from the allottee. These taxis shall also be available to the public on hire on kilometer basis to be fixed by GTDC. For the information of public and tourists, taxi numbers and mobile numbers of drivers shall be displayed at prominent places.

ENTERTAINMENT SOCIETY OF GOA

- The Entertainment Society of Goa (ESG) is the nodal agency for organizing IFFI in Goa. The ESG has hosted 35th, 36th, 37th & 38th IFFI in Goa for the last four years from the year 2004 to 2007. The ticketing system was used for the first time for 38th IFFI by ESG and it is for the first time for any film festival held in India. The ticketing system was a great success in reducing the queue system before the screening of each film. The office of the ESG is fully computerized and networked with WIFI facilities. ESG bid away with the Cornice

activities during the IFFI, thereby saving the additional cost on peripheral activities.

- The ESG is also looking at using the existing upgraded facilities like theatre, museum space, press conference room, office space etc. for subletting to private companies to generate revenue.
- The Goa State Infrastructure Development Corporation (GSIDC) has developed a world class infrastructure for the IFFI 2007 and for the coming festivals. GSIDC has repaired the old Food and Drugs Building, Maquinez palace which was in dilapidated state and converted it in to the office premises for the Entertainment Society of Goa, Directorate of Film Festival and Press Information Bureau and two theatres.
- The Entertainment Society of Goa has requested public to give their opinion for the adaptive reuse of the old GMC Building.
- The ESG has its own website www.iffigoa.org.

Revenue generated by ESG

a) The ESG receives rent from M/s Inox Leisure Ltd. for operation of Multiplex on leave and license basis to the tune of Rs. 3.79 crore per annum.

b) The Society has been making efforts to generate sponsorship from various companies during International Film Festival of India so as to make the film festival a self-sustaining activity.

c) The ESG has been designated as single window clearance agency for granting film shooting permission in the State of Goa. The Society has earned revenue of around Rs. 12.91 lakh till date from this activity.